Alexandra "Ola" Zalecki

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EDUCATION

Middlebury College **Middlebury, VT**
Bachelor of Arts in Geography with a minor in Spanish *May 2024*
Summa Cum Laude and with Honors for completion of Senior Thesis
"Who is the public in our public libraries? Exploring the spatial variations of the changing dynamics of library services in Chicago, IL"

Relevant Coursework: Human Geography with GIS, Intro Cartography, Mapping Global Environmental Change, Practicing Human Geography, Cartographic Design, OpenGIScience

Technical Skills: desktop GIS(QGIS, ArcGIS), web based GIS (Google Earth Engine, ArcGIS Online & StoryMaps), Adobe Suite (Illustrator, Photoshop, InDesign), RStudio, STATA, Github, Canvas, Prairie Learn

Language Skills: English (native proficiency), Polish (native proficiency), Spanish (working proficiency)

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Middlebury College, Department of Luso-Hispanic Studies **Middlebury, VT**
Research Assistant, Professor Miguel Fernández *January 2024 - May 2024*
- Completed background research on the 19th century shipwreck of the Orus in the San Juan River in Nicaragua using academic texts and historical records
- Designed and produced a number of static thematic and locator maps to be included in an ArcGIS story map.
- Created a data entry form to be used to input data during field work

Middlebury College, Department of Geography **Middlebury, VT**
Global Atlas Research Assistant, Professor Guntram Herb *February 2022 - September 2023*
- Conducted background research and collected and edited data for a variety of global topics to create an atlas textbook for introductory-level college courses in international studies
- Managed a team of 5 research assistants to create a working map template in QGIS and Adobe Illustrator to streamline map production
- Collaborated on completing at least 50 thematic maps in total

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Middlebury College, Department of Geography **Middlebury, VT**
Assistant in Science Instruction *August 2024 - Present*
- Work closely with faculty to assist in developing lab and lecture materials
- Support instruction of GIS lectures and labs by grading
- Hold regular office hours and work individually with students outside designated class time to help them complete assignments
- Provide support for students pursuing independent studies and theses by helping them find suitable data, discussing technical issues, determining appropriate methods, etc
- Hire, mentor, and supervise, student lab monitors
- Maintain GIS databases and software for the department as well as the department's, computer labs, student work areas, and printers

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Freelance Cartographer **Bristol, VT**
Freelancer, Dr. Barry Rodrigue *October 2025 - Present*
- Design and produce thematic and reference maps primarily for academic print publication

The Newberry Library **Chicago, IL**
Intern, Smith Center for the History of Cartography *Summer 2023*

- Alphabetized USGS maps to improve future cross-referencing with cataloged material
- Created and managed an inventory of previously unprocessed Rand McNally and French Marine maps
- Cropped and adjusted metadata for 150 map images for the online companion archive to the publication: Mapping Movement in American History and Culture
- Completed a digital file name check and BibID retrieval for 180 catalog entries for the Sacks map collection

Middlebury College, Department of Geography **Middlebury, VT**
GIS Database Design Intern, Bill Hegman *September 2022 - May 2023*

- Digitized an outdated land management database in ArcGIS Pro and ArcGIS Online to improve parcel record keeping for Middlebury College
- Coordinated with administrators and differents to verify spatial accuracy and improve user experience of the new digital database

Addison County Regional Planning Commission **Middlebury, VT**
Intern *January 2023 - February 2023*

- Collected various types of economic and traffic data to prepare maps, graphs, and other visualizations to show land use and change along a road bypass
- Attended project meetings with local planners to identify project goals and later present results from my analysis
- Created a final report documenting analysis and a discussion of recommendations for future road bypass projects

CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

2022 **Globalscapes: An Atlas | Poster**
Presented with Drew An-Pham, Annika Hoerner, Yidu "Alex" Xu and Madeleine Gallop
Summer Research Symposium at Middlebury College

2023 **Mapping the Impacts of the Alternate Truck Route in Morrisville, VT | Poster**
Spring Student Symposium at Middlebury College

2024 **The Coal Mine Next Door | Map**
Mountain Cartography Workshop in Zakopane, Poland

2025 **Who is the Public in Our Public Libraries? Exploring the Spatial Variations of Library Services in Chicago, IL | Paper**
American Association of Geographers Annual Meeting in Detroit, MI

2025 **The Forest Preserves of the Northwest Side | Map**
NACIS Annual Meeting in Louisville, KY

HONORS, AWARDS AND SCHOLARSHIPS

2020 Illinois State Scholar
2020-2021, 2023 Middlebury College Scholar
2021-2022 Middlebury College Dean's List
2022 Beinecke Scholarship nominee for Middlebury College
2024 J Rowland Illick Prize in Geography
Awarded to a graduating geography senior whose achievements best exemplify Professor Illick's standards of excellence and humanitarian concern

PUBLICATIONS

Herb, G. H., Moorti, S., Fuentes-George, K., (2024). Middlebury Atlas of Globalization. April 2024, PONS Langenscheidt GmbH, Stuttgart, Germany

Description of Contribution: Conducted background research, collected data, and created maps for the atlas.

VOLUNTEER WORK

Tutors4Ukraine **Middlebury, VT**
Remote Tutor *April 2022-August 2022*

- Provided one-on-one English and Polish language tutoring and instruction to develop reading and speaking skills
- Developed weekly grammar-based lesson plans and made annotations of student learning and progress
- Provided supplemental academic support and writing activities for the student outside of tutoring sessions

Connections for the Homeless **Evanston, IL**
Interpreter and Translator *Summer 2021*

- Interpreted and translated conversations and verbal instructions between Polish and English
- Reviewed and translated government documents and forms in both languages
- Facilitated effective communication between the organization and the client.

CERTIFICATES

2019 Seal of Biliteracy in English and Polish